

Alienware X14 R2

Thin and light but outperformed by laptops less than half its price

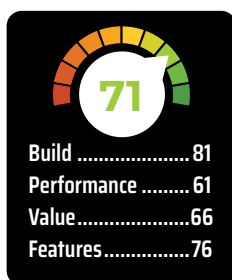


The Alienware X14 R2 is Dell's premium

14-inch gaming laptop offering. It continues to be the thinnest 14-inch gaming laptop in the market, making this a portable and compact machine that can easily accompany you anywhere for some on-the-go gaming. Despite the size, the Alienware X14 R2 is packing the latest 13th gen Intel Core i7 processor which is paired with an RTX 4060 Laptop GPU. With a price tag of Rs 2,51,490 the Alienware X14 R2 certainly isn't cheap; we've seen plenty of laptops with similar or better specs at much lower price points. However, none of them offer the same level of build quality or portability that the X14 R2 does. That said, let's take a look at how well the Alienware X14 R2 performs and if it truly is worth the premium you're paying for it.

BUILD AND DESIGN

Continuing Alienware's tradition of delivering premium gaming machines with sleek and attractive designs, the



Alienware X14 R2 features a futuristic and eye-catching design that sets it apart from traditional gaming laptops.

The first thing you'll notice is the colour. The 'Lunar Silver' colour variant is the only one available, and it is incredibly eye-

catching. Unlike last year's model, the lid features a more metallic finish, as opposed to the egg-shell matte finish. You have the signature alien head logo illuminated on the lid and an embossed X on the lid representing the series. At 14.5 mm the Alienware X14 R2 continues to be the thinnest 14-inch gaming laptop you can get your hands on and it is truly impressive that they managed to fit a discrete GPU into this machine.

The Alienware X14 R2 felt incredibly sturdy and well-built in our hands. They certainly didn't hold back at all when it comes to build quality. The hinge mechanism also feels very sturdy and allows for smooth opening and closing of the laptop lid with little to no wobbling.

The keyboard offers a comfortable typing experience with good key travel

and tactile feedback. Additionally, it includes anti-ghosting and N-key rollover features, which is pretty essential for any gaming laptop. The 14-inch form factor does mean that you have a smaller keyboard and no numpad, but overall spacing is still good and comfortable.

The trackpad is pretty small, and as such, doesn't get in the way much while you're typing. You're most likely going to be using an external mouse for gaming anyway.

I/O

As far as 14-inch form factor laptops are concerned, the Alienware X14 R2 does pretty well in the I/O department. You have a USB-C 3.2 Gen 2 with PD and DP, a combo audio jack, an HDMI 2.1 port, a USB-A 3.2 Gen 1 port with PowerShare (this is a feature in Dell laptops which allows you to charge devices even if the laptop is off as long as it is plugged in), two Thunderbolt 4 ports with PD and DP and a microSD-card slot. Very nice.

PERFORMANCE

With that, we come to the performance. The X14 R2 features a 13th gen Intel Core i7-13620H processor which is paired with an NVIDIA GeForce RTX 4060 Laptop GPU. Having tested several laptops this year featuring various CPU and GPU combinations, the specs on the Alienware X14 R2 are quite frankly underwhelming, especially for the price. While the X14 R2 certainly has the upper hand when it comes to build quality and portability, in terms of performance it falls short. For this review, we'll be comparing the Alienware X14 R2 to the Acer Predator Helios Neo 16 we tested recently. The Helios Neo 16 features a slightly better processor in the 13th gen Intel Core i7-13700HX. As for the GPUs, we'll be comparing the RTX 4050 with a TGP of 115W in the Neo 16 to the RTX 4060 with a TGP of 85W in the Alienware X14 R2 to show you just how much of a difference TGP can make. We should also point out that the Acer Predator Helios Neo 16 costs half as much as the Alienware X14 R2.